

EMPATHY: THE PURSUIT OF JOY — A HERO'S JOURNEY

A documentary film experience with the power to heal your mind, body, and soul.

A premium 90-minute feature documentary — a cinematic sonic experience combining ancient wisdom, proven by science, with measured mind, body, and soul impact. Five transformational elements: Tibetan & Indian Buddhism, Jungian psychology, the Hero’s Journey, neuroscience — and the fifth, empathy, the most underrated tool of personal actualization. Empathy is our core human technology: it delivers oxytocin, reduces cortisol, and opens the felt shift — the shift you can feel — that turns challenges into forward movement.

The problem

Global anxiety, loneliness, emotional dysregulation, and polarization are at historic highs. Everyone is selling self-regulation in fragments — meditation apps, breathwork, sound baths: essentially Buddhism, branded differently — while people still lack practical tools for the actual moment of stress. People feel crappy and they just want to feel better. Existing content intellectualizes, lacks measurable outcomes, and fails to reach non-spiritual audiences.

The solution

The film delivers empathy as an embodied, experiential intervention — story, music, and neuroscience helping audiences feel, understand, and apply empathy & compassion in daily life. Whether you are a monk, a maximum-security prisoner, a rock star, or the rest of us — if they can do this, you can do anything. Accessible, measurable, fun, and actionable across entertainment, wellness, education, leadership, and institutional settings.

GLOBAL WELLNESS ECONOMY \$6.3T	WOMEN'S WELLNESS \$360B	LEADERSHIP & CONSCIOUS BUSINESS \$90B	ALT & INTEGRATIVE MEDICINE \$145B
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THE PROOF ENGINE · MILESTONES

Measured, not asserted. **Already shooting.**

Milestones to date

65% of principal photography shot (RED KOMODO 6K); four Dharamshala shoots, 20+ TB of footage

Rare access: the Dalai Lama, Tibetan monks, nuns, historians, artists, musicians & the Dalai Lama's AI Center

Sound-bath soundtrack underway with Maejor, the Tibetan Music Institute, and a Creative Music Lab for Tibetan Children's Village students

Initial string-outs of ordinary heroes' true stories; brand-beyond-the-film development (mindset, movement, masterclass)

What we measure

Every element — film segments, narration, original music, chanting, breath-paced sound, neuroacoustic/binaural elements, contemplative visual art, guided reflection — treated as a research stimulus: prototyped, measured, revised, tested. Outcomes: self-regulation and co-regulation for individuals, couples, families, and communities, short- and long-term. Per the Templeton Foundation proposal, submitted July 2026. Third-party validated, with sponsor-ready case studies.

Timeline: AUG '26 film completion · NOV '26 "Initial Cut" premiere at the Dalai Lama's Dharamshala International Film Festival (DIFF) · 2026–27 festivals & distribution.

Revenue architecture — layered, diversified, long-tail

Traditional distribution (SVOD · AVOD/FAST · TVOD · fan site) plus scalable extensions: Experiences — music + wellbeing events and retreats, recurring return-customer revenue with network partners ready (Taylor Renee, LA event producer, LCSC.LA; Jimmy Bell, DJ — events & retreats) · screenings · curriculum & educational licensing · sound-bath subscription audio · immersive exhibitions · Empathy-brand apparel with neuroscience-curated materials (with collaborator Suz, dinoapparel.com botanic line) · books, masterclasses, courses & app. IP: feature + 10-part series rights, proprietary healing harmonics, retreat formats.

Conservative financials & projections

Year	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	2031
Revenue	\$0.25M	\$1.5M	\$3.0M	\$3.75M	\$4.25M	\$5.2M
EBITDA	(\$0.15M)	\$0.5M	\$1.2M	\$1.8M	\$1.9M	\$2.1M

Per the project one-sheet. EBITDA-positive from 2027.

THE TEAM · THE ASK

Assembled, credentialed, *already in the field.*

Dr. Natalie Petouhoff

Executive Producer / Story Architect / Writer. WSJ bestselling author (Empathy in Action, 15 industry awards), PhD scientist (UCLA).

Josh Sikkema

Director-Cinematographer. Award-winning; music-driven, human-centered storytelling; 1B+ streams across collaborations; Crain's 40 Under 40.

Maejor

Musical Director / Sonic Architect. Multi-platinum, Grammy-nominated; producer on Justin Bieber's 2025 album Swag; neuro-acoustic healing harmonics.

Scientific Advisory Board (neuroscience, psychology, contemplative science, human-centered AI): Jason Snell · Kimi Doan · Paul Zak, PhD · Jessizza-Pade · Paul Edge, PhD · Kirsty Allan, PhD · Dr. Thompson · Kelly Bollman · Jacob Marshal. Research lineage: Harvard, Stanford, Wisconsin, Columbia, UCSD, Emory (77M+ trained in compassion practices across 24 countries).

1

INVESTMENT — COMPLETION FUNDS

Final Dharamshala + US shoots, score & sonic-healing architecture, third-party impact measurement, post-production to Netflix delivery readiness, DIFF premiere & festival run.

\$850K

Lanes: equity · grants (Templeton Foundation proposal, submitted July 2026) · brand sponsorship · tax-deductible donations via fiscal sponsor From the Heart Productions (501c3). How to Be a Good Human, Delaware Public Benefit Corporation, Marina Del Rey, CA. Contact: Dr. Natalie Petouhoff · 310-919-8467 · DoctorNatalie@gmail.com · Josh Sikkema · 616-389-4918 · IG /theherosjourney_doc.

It's not about becoming a monk, changing your religion, or meditating on mountaintops — *it's about connecting to your inner wisdom.*